

Pre-Digital Evidence — Psychological and Physiological Response Continuity

Pre-digital research on street prostitution, brothel systems, and early ethnographic studies consistently documents the emergence of detachment, dissociation, and emotional suppression as functional adaptations to repeated sexualized interactions under conditions of boundary negotiation and adversarial exchange. Observational and interview-based studies describe participants developing cognitive distancing strategies to maintain operational capacity, alongside routine exposure to boundary testing, coercive pressure, and interactional asymmetry. Post-exit analyses further identify persistent psychological effects, including trauma-related symptoms, identity disruption, and difficulty reintegrating into non-participation contexts. These patterns are recorded across informal (street-based) and regulated (brothel) environments, indicating that such responses are not environment-specific but arise from the underlying conditions of participation. The consistency of these documented responses prior to digital platforms supports classification of these outcomes as predictable adaptations rather than isolated or individual reactions. This aligns with the broader finding that harm patterns observed in contemporary systems reflect historically continuous mechanisms rather than novel phenomena .

Citations (Pre-Digital / Foundational Research)

- Farley, M. et al. (2003) — *Prostitution in Five Countries*
- Brents, B. & Hausbeck, K. (2005) — *Violence and Legalized Brothel Prostitution in Nevada*
- Hoigard, C. & Finstad, L. (1992) — *Backstreets: Prostitution, Money and Love*
- Phoenix, J. (1999) — *Making Sense of Prostitution*
- O'Neill, M. (2001) — *Prostitution and Feminism: Towards a Politics of Feeling*